

Religion and Philosophy from Zero - The Foundation Track

Chapter F5.3 — From Zero: Why the Sixth Century BCE Produced Reformers, and Jainism, Buddhism and the Heterodox Sects in Full

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NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

On the evidence of the verified 2023 paper this is the highest-yield chapter in Module 5, because religion, philosophy and the art they produced is where history questions have clustered. F5.2 left two pressures building - sacrifice grown costly and priest-dominated, and a new commercial class with wealth but no rank in a birth-fixed varna order, concentrated in the less orthodox eastern republics. This chapter is what happened when those pressures met. Session 1 sets out the six causes and the wider heterodox landscape, including the Ajivikas and the materialist Charvakas. Sessions 2 and 3 teach Jainism and Buddhism from zero - founders, life events with their places, doctrines, the councils, the sects, the canonical literature, and the architecture each produced. Session 4 puts the two side by side on the twelve points that separate them, explains why Buddhism nearly vanished from India while Jainism did not, and notes the orthodox response. Study time 4 hours.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. The traditional dates for the Buddha (563-483 BCE) and Mahavira (540-468 BCE) are printed because they are what option sets use, but a substantial body of scholarship places the Buddha roughly a century later, and that dispute is named where it arises rather than concealed. Council dates and the attribution of particular doctrinal developments to particular councils follow the standard tradition. Sanskrit and Pali forms of the same term differ (dharma / dhamma, nirvana / nibbana, atman / atta) and both are given at first use, since the paper uses both.

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0. Why This Is the Chapter to Get Right

If you learn one chapter in Module 5 properly, learn this one. The evidence says so plainly.

PYQ CONNECTION · THE EVIDENCE FOR THIS CHAPTER'S PRIORITY

F5.1 established the finding: of the **10 history questions in the verified 2023 paper, NINE were ancient, medieval or art-and-culture**. Within that nine, **religion, philosophy and the art they produced is the largest single cluster** - because the material is ideally shaped for a four-option paper. It is full of **named founders, numbered doctrines, dated councils, paired sects and identifiable monuments**, which is exactly what recognition questions are made of.

Four numbered sets from this chapter alone are standard question material:

- 1 **Four** Noble Truths and the **Eightfold** Path
- 2 **Five** vows of Jainism, and the **Triratna** of each religion - and they are **different Triratnas**, which is itself a trap
- 3 **Four** Buddhist councils, each with a king, a place and an outcome
- 4 **Twenty-four** Jain Tirthankaras, of whom **two** matter

And the chapter pays twice. The stupa, the chaitya and the vihara are Buddhist forms; the rock-cut caves at Ellora and Udayagiri are substantially Jain. **So every monument you place here is a monument you do not have to learn again in F5.5**, which is the module's other high-yield chapter. **Treat this chapter as the foundation of the art chapter, not as a separate topic.**

WHY THIS EXISTS · THE TWO PRESSURES F5.2 LEFT BUILDING

This chapter does not begin with the Buddha, because that would leave you memorising a biography instead of understanding a movement. **It begins with the question: why did a wave of religious reform break out across the eastern Ganga plain in the sixth century BCE, and why then?**

F5.2 left two pressures explicitly unresolved:

- 1 **Religious.** Later Vedic sacrifice had become **elaborate, expensive and priest-dominated**. The Upanishads had already begun questioning it **from inside** the tradition - asking whether ritual accomplished anything at all
- 2 **Social and economic.** The second urbanisation produced **setthis** (merchant-bankers) and **gahapatis** (substantial householders) - people with **wealth but no rank**, because the hardened varna order fixed status by birth. **A Vaishya trader could be the richest man in Shravasti and still rank below a penniless Brahmana**

A religion that measures worth by conduct rather than by birth, and that does not require an expensive animal sacrifice, answers both pressures at once. That is what Jainism and Buddhism offered, and it is why the merchant class funded them so heavily - a pattern visible for centuries afterwards in the donor inscriptions on stupa railings.

Hold that as the chapter's organising idea. The doctrines are not arbitrary: **each one is a solution to a specific grievance against the Vedic order**, and Session 1 works the mapping out in full.

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F5.3 - THE FOUR SESSIONS

- 1 **Session 1 - Why reform, and the wider landscape:** the six causes, and the heterodox sects beyond the famous two, including the Ajivikas and the materialist Charvakas (Section 1)
- 2 **Session 2 - Jainism:** Mahavira, the Tirthankaras, the five vows, the doctrines, the councils, the two sects, the literature and the architecture (Section 2)
- 3 **Session 3 - Buddhism:** the Buddha's life by place, the Four Noble Truths and the Eightfold Path, the doctrines, the four councils, the three schools, the Tripitaka and the architecture (Section 3)
- 4 **Session 4 - Comparison and aftermath:** the twelve points separating the two, why Buddhism nearly disappeared from India while Jainism survived, and the orthodox response (Section 4)

Then **42 graded questions**.

1. Session 1 - Why the Sixth Century BCE, and the Wider Heterodoxy ★★★★★

Two men are remembered. Sixty-odd movements were competing, and knowing that changes how you read the two that won.

START FROM ZERO · ORTHODOX AND HETERODOX - THE WORDS, AND WHAT THEY CLASSIFY

Indian philosophical traditions are conventionally sorted by **one test only: does the school accept the authority of the Vedas?**

- 1 **ASTIKA** (orthodox) - accepts Vedic authority. **The six schools from F5.2:** Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, Vedanta
- 2 **NASTIKA** (heterodox) - rejects Vedic authority. **Three: Buddhism, Jainism and Charvaka** (also called Lokayata)

Get the test right, because the words are routinely misused. In modern usage *astika* is often taken to mean "theist" and *nastika* "atheist", **and that is not what they mean here.** The classification is about **scriptural authority, not about belief in God:**

- 1 **Samkhya is astika** - it accepts the Vedas - **yet it is essentially non-theistic**
- 2 **Mimamsa is astika** and is concerned with ritual injunction rather than with a personal God
- 3 **Jainism is nastika** and **does not posit a creator God**, but it is intensely concerned with the soul and with liberation
- 4 **Buddhism is nastika** and is **silent on a creator God** while affirming karma and rebirth

So the examinable formulation is: the astika-nastika divide turns on acceptance of the Vedas, NOT on theism. A question offering "atheistic" as the definition of nastika is offering the popular error, and **the standard trio to name when asked for the nastika schools is Buddhism, Jainism and Charvaka.**

MUST MASTER · THE SIX CAUSES OF THE SIXTH-CENTURY REFORM MOVEMENTS

Asked directly as "causes of the rise of Buddhism and Jainism", and the answer is a list. Learn it as three pairs.

Religious pair:

- 1 **Sacrifice had become costly and elaborate.** Rituals demanded animals, ghee and fees, which impoverished the ordinary householder and enriched the priesthood
- 2 **The Upanishadic critique already existed.** The questioning came from **inside** the Vedic tradition, so the reformers were pushing a door already ajar

Social pair:

- 1 **The varna order had hardened** into hereditary rank, closing advancement to the able
- 2 **The Kshatriyas resented Brahmana supremacy.** Note that **both Mahavira and the Buddha were Kshatriyas**, and both movements drew royal patronage early

Economic pair:

- 1 **A new commercial class had wealth but no status** - the setthis and gahapatis of F5.2 - and both religions offered them dignity and, in Buddhism's case, an ethic compatible with commerce
- 2 **Ahimsa suited an agrarian and trading economy.** Animal sacrifice destroyed the **cattle** that ploughed the fields, and **ahimsa was therefore economically rational as well as ethically appealing** - a point worth making because it is the least obvious of the six and the most impressive to state

Two enabling conditions on top of the six. The movements preached in **Prakrit and Pali - the languages people actually spoke** - rather than in Sanskrit, which the Vedic tradition reserved for ritual; and they arose in the **eastern republics**, outside the Brahmanical heartland, where **the Buddha was a Shakya and Mahavira was connected with the Vajji. Language plus geography is why the message travelled.**

1.1 The heterodox landscape beyond the famous two

Buddhist texts speak of a great many contemporary teachers - the tradition names **sixty-two or sixty-three** sects. **Four are worth recognising, and one of them is genuinely examinable.**

School	Founder or figure	The doctrine, and what is asked
Ajivika	Makkhali Gosala	Strict determinism (niyati) - everything is fixed by fate, and no act of will alters one's destiny, so effort is pointless. A serious rival to Buddhism for centuries, patronised by Ashoka's family and mentioned in his edicts. The name to pair with fatalism
Charvaka / Lokayata	Ajita Kesakambalin in the Buddhist lists; the school is traditionally traced to Brihaspati	Materialism. Only what is perceived exists; there is no soul, no rebirth, no karma and no afterlife, so pleasure in this life is the only rational aim. The one nastika school that is NOT a religion , and the standard answer for "materialist school of Indian philosophy"
Ajnana	Sanjaya Belatthaputta	Scepticism - metaphysical questions cannot be answered at all, so judgement should be suspended. A recognisable ancestor of agnosticism
Akriyavada	Purana Kassapa	Denial that action produces moral consequence - the rejection of karma as an ethical mechanism

The other heterodox schools of the sixth century BCE

HIGH YIELD · WHAT TO HOLD FROM THIS TABLE, AND WHY THE LOSERS MATTER

Two pairings only, and they are cheap marks:

- 1 **Makkhali Gosala = Ajivika = determinism / niyati**
- 2 **Charvaka = Lokayata = materialism**, and it is the **third nastika school** alongside Buddhism and Jainism

Why the failed movements are worth five minutes at all. Because they show that **Buddhism and Jainism were not the only options and did not win automatically.** They won on features the others lacked: **an organised monastic order (the sangha), a workable ethic for lay followers, and sustained royal and merchant patronage.**

That is a genuinely useful analytical point and it will serve you in an interview: the Ajivikas had a doctrine and no durable institution, and they disappeared. Buddhism had both, and it reached Japan. Doctrine without organisation does not survive - **which is the same lesson your own service teaches about schemes without delivery machinery**, and a fair thing to say if the panel asks what history is good for.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

- 1 State the test that divides astika from nastika, and why "atheist" is the wrong gloss
- 2 Name the six astika and the three nastika schools
- 3 Give the six causes of the reform movements, as three pairs
- 4 Why was ahimsa economically rational, not merely ethically appealing?
- 5 Name the two enabling conditions of language and geography
- 6 Pair Makkhali Gosala and Ajita Kesakambalin with their schools and doctrines
- 7 Which heterodox school is not a religion at all, and what does it hold?
- 8 Why did Buddhism and Jainism outlast the Ajivikas?

2. Session 2 - Jainism ★★★★★

Older than Buddhism, never as widespread, and still here. Its distinguishing move is that it takes the soul absolutely seriously.

MUST MASTER · MAHAVIRA - THE LIFE, BY PLACE

Jainism does not begin with Mahavira. The tradition counts **twenty-four Tirthankaras** - "ford-makers", those who build a crossing over the river of rebirth - and Mahavira is the **twenty-fourth and last**, a reformer of an existing tradition rather than a founder. **Stating this correctly is itself a question**, because the option "Mahavira founded Jainism" is offered and is wrong on the tradition's own terms.

- 1 **First Tirthankara: Rishabhanatha** (also Adinatha), whose emblem is the **bull**. **Mentioned in the Rig Veda and the Vishnu Purana**, which is the basis of Jainism's claim to great antiquity
- 2 **Twenty-third Tirthankara: Parshvanatha**, conventionally placed in the **eighth century BCE**, emblem the **serpent**. **He taught the FIRST FOUR vows; Mahavira added the fifth**
- 3 **Twenty-fourth: Mahavira**, emblem the **lion**

Mahavira's life, learned as places rather than dates:

- 1 **Born c. 540 BCE at Kundagrama**, near **Vaishali** - so in **Vajji** territory, the republic of F5.2
 - 2 **Clan the Jnatrika**; father **Siddhartha**, a clan chief; mother **Trishala**, sister of the Lichchavi chief Chetaka. **Kshatriya by birth**
 - 3 Original name **Vardhamana**. Married **Yashoda**
 - 4 **Renounced at 30**, after his parents' death
 - 5 **Twelve years of austerity**, for part of it in company with Makkhali Gosala of the Ajivikas
 - 6 **Attained kaivalya at 42** - omniscience, perfect knowledge - at **Jrimbhikagrama** under a sal tree. From then he is **Mahavira** ("great hero"), **Jina** ("conqueror", from which "Jain"), and **Kevalin**
 - 7 **Preached for thirty years** in Prakrit; his chief patrons included **Bimbisara and Ajatashatru** of Magadha
 - 8 **Died c. 468 BCE at Pavapuri**, in Bihar, aged 72. The Jain term for his death is **nirvana**
- The three names to keep apart: Vardhamana is the birth name, Mahavira and Jina are titles acquired at kaivalya, and Tirthankara is the office.**

MUST MASTER · THE DOCTRINES - EACH ONE ANSWERING A GRIEVANCE

THE FIVE VOWS (pancha mahavrat / anuvrata). Learn the Sanskrit, because the paper uses it:

- 1 **Ahimsa** - non-injury to any living being. **The supreme vow, and Jain ahimsa is the most rigorous in Indian thought**
- 2 **Satya** - truthfulness
- 3 **Asteya** - non-stealing
- 4 **Aparigraha** - non-possession, non-attachment to property
- 5 **Brahmacharya** - chastity or celibacy. **This is the fifth, and it is the one MAHAVIRA ADDED to Parshvanatha's four**

THE TRIRATNA - the three jewels of Jainism. Note carefully that **this is a different Triratna from Buddhism's**, and confusing the two is a standard trap:

- 1 **Samyak darshana** - right faith
- 2 **Samyak jnana** - right knowledge
- 3 **Samyak charitra** - right conduct

THE METAPHYSICS, in four terms:

- 1 **Jiva and Ajiva** - the living (soul) and the non-living. **Jainism holds that souls exist in everything, including plants and even particles of earth** - which is why its ahimsa is so demanding
- 2 **Karma** - understood as a **material substance** that adheres to the soul and weighs it down. Liberation is the shedding of accumulated karma through austerity
- 3 **Kaivalya / moksha** - liberation, the soul freed from karma and from rebirth. **Achieved by austerity and self-mortification, NOT by divine grace, because there is no creator God to grant it**
- 4 **Syadvada and anekantavada** - the doctrines of "**maybe**" and of **many-sidedness**: reality has many aspects and any single statement about it is true only conditionally. **The parable of the blind men and the elephant is the standard illustration**

SALLEKHANA - the practice of voluntary fasting to death when the body can no longer support religious life. **It is the most distinctive and most examinable Jain practice**, and it follows logically: if liberation is achieved by shedding karma through austerity, austerity carried to its end is the final act.

Where Jainism agrees with the Vedic order and where it breaks. It accepts karma and rebirth, so it is not a rejection of the whole framework. It **rejects Vedic authority, animal sacrifice, the necessity of priests, and birth-based status** - and it **denies a creator God. That combination is the answer to "how does Jainism differ from Vedic religion"**.

2.1 Councils, sects, literature

Council	When and where	What happened
First	Pataliputra , in the reign of Chandragupta Maurya (c. 3rd century BCE), under Sthulabhadra	Convened after a long famine had scattered the community. Bhadrabahu had led a group south to Karnataka during the famine; on their return the two groups disagreed over whether monks must go naked. This is the origin of the sectarian split
Second	Valabhi , Gujarat, 512 CE (some sources 454 CE), under Devardhi Kshamasramana	The canon was finally written down, in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit. Until then it was transmitted orally, which is why the tradition's earlier history is textually thin

The two Jain councils and the sectarian split

The two sects, and the distinction is a single question:

- 1 **Digambara** - "sky-clad". Monks go **naked**, following Mahavira's own practice strictly. Associated with **Bhadrabahu's** southern group. Holds that **women cannot attain liberation** without first being reborn as men
- 2 **Svetambara** - "white-clad". Monks wear **white cloth**. Associated with **Sthulabhadra's** group that stayed in Magadha. Holds that **women can attain liberation**

Literature. The canon is the **Agamas**, of which the twelve **Angas** are the core; the **Kalpasutra** is by **Bhadrabahu**. The language is **Prakrit**, specifically **Ardhamagadhi** - and the deliberate choice of the spoken language over Sanskrit is the same move Buddhism made.

KNOW · ROYAL PATRONAGE, SPREAD, AND THE ARCHITECTURE JAINISM PRODUCED

Patrons worth naming: Bimbisara and Ajatashatru in Mahavira's own lifetime; **Chandragupta Maurya**, who by tradition became a Jain and died by sallekhana at **Shravanabelagola**; **Kharavela of Kalinga**, whose **Hathigumpha inscription** at Udayagiri records his patronage; and later the **Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas and Gangas** in the Deccan and Karnataka.

Why Jainism stayed small but survived. It never became a state religion of an empire the way Buddhism did under Ashoka, and **its extreme austerity limited mass appeal** - a merchant can practise ahimsa, a farmer who must plough cannot easily. But **that same merchant base was durable, urban and wealthy**, and it kept the tradition alive in Gujarat, Rajasthan and Karnataka to the present day. **Buddhism won the empire and lost the country; Jainism never won the empire and never lost its community** - a contrast worth holding for Session 4.

The architecture, which F5.5 will reuse:

- 1 **Dilwara temples**, Mount Abu, Rajasthan - **marble carving of extraordinary fineness**, built under the Solankis. The single most-asked Jain monument
- 2 **Gomateshwara / Bahubali statue, Shravanabelagola**, Karnataka - a **monolithic** statue about **57 feet** high, raised under the Western Gangas by the minister **Chavundaraya**
- 3 **Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves**, Odisha - Jain rock-cut caves, and the site of **Kharavela's Hathigumpha inscription**
- 4 **Ellora**, Maharashtra - **caves 30 to 34 are Jain**, including the **Indra Sabha**. Ellora's three-faith composition (Buddhist, Hindu, Jain) is itself a standard question
- 5 **Ranakpur** (Rajasthan), **Palitana / Shatrunjaya** and **Girnar** (Gujarat) - major temple complexes

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

- 1 Why is it wrong to say Mahavira founded Jainism, and what is a Tirthankara?
- 2 Name the first and twenty-third Tirthankaras with their emblems, and what Parshvanatha taught
- 3 Give Mahavira's birthplace, clan, parents, birth name, and the ages of renunciation and kaivalya
- 4 Where did he attain kaivalya, and where did he die?
- 5 Name the five vows in Sanskrit, and say which one Mahavira added
- 6 Give the Jain Triratna, and say why it must not be confused with Buddhism's
- 7 Explain jiva/ajiva, karma as substance, and why Jain ahimsa is so demanding
- 8 What are syadvada and sallekhana?
- 9 Give both councils with king or convener, place and outcome
- 10 Distinguish Digambara from Svetambara on dress and on women's liberation
- 11 Name four Jain monuments with their locations

3. Session 3 - Buddhism ★★★★★

The same social crisis, a milder answer, and an institution good enough to cross Asia.

MUST MASTER · THE BUDDHA - THE LIFE, BY PLACE

Learn this life as a sequence of PLACES. Every one of them is a question, and the places are also the pilgrimage sites and therefore the monuments of F5.5.

- 1 **Born c. 563 BCE at Lumbini**, in the **Shakya** republic, in present-day **Nepal**. Personal name **Siddhartha**, clan name **Gautama**
- 2 **Father Suddhodana**, chief of the Shakyas; mother **Maha Maya**, who died soon after the birth; brought up by his aunt **Prajapati Gautami**. **Kshatriya by birth**, like Mahavira
- 3 Married **Yashodhara**; son **Rahula**
- 4 **The Great Renunciation - Mahabhinishkramana - at 29**, prompted by the **four sights**: an old man, a sick man, a corpse, and an ascetic
- 5 Studied under **Alara Kalama** and **Ramaputta Uddaka**, then practised severe austerity for six years and **abandoned it as useless** - which is the origin of the **Middle Path**
- 6 **Enlightenment - nirvana / bodhi - at 35 at Bodh Gaya**, on the **Niranjana (Falgu)** river, under a **pipal** tree. From then he is the **Buddha**, "the enlightened one", and also **Tathagata** and **Shakyamuni**
- 7 **First sermon at Sarnath**, near Varanasi, to five disciples - called the **Dharmachakra Pravartana**, "setting in motion the wheel of law"
- 8 **Preached for 45 years** in **Pali**, the spoken language. Patrons included **Bimbisara** and **Ajatashatru** of Magadha and **Prasenajit** of Kosala
- 9 **Died c. 483 BCE at Kushinagar**, aged 80, among the **Malla** people. His death is the **Mahaparinirvana**

The five places to fix absolutely: LUMBINI birth, BODH GAYA enlightenment, SARNATH first sermon, KUSHINAGAR death - and Vaishali, where he preached often and where the Second Council was later held. **A question naming any one of these four events expects the matching place, and this is the single most reliable question in the whole chapter.**

On the dates. The traditional **563-483 BCE** is what option sets use and is what you should answer. **A substantial body of modern scholarship places the Buddha about a century later, around 480-400 BCE.** State the traditional dates, and know that the revision exists.

MUST MASTER · THE DOCTRINE - THE NUMBERED SETS THAT CARRY THE MARKS

THE FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS (chatvari arya satyani). The whole of Buddhism in four propositions, and it is a diagnosis followed by a prescription:

- 1 **Dukkha** - there is suffering
- 2 **Dukkha samudaya** - suffering has a cause, which is **desire or craving (trishna / tanha)**
- 3 **Dukkha nirodha** - suffering can be ended, by ending craving
- 4 **Dukkha nirodha marga** - there is a path to that ending, which is the Eightfold Path

THE EIGHTFOLD PATH (ashtangika marga) - right **view, intention, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness** and **concentration**. **You need to recognise the eight, not recite them in order.** Note **right livelihood** in particular: an ethic that judges how a man earns his living speaks directly to the merchant class of Session 1.

THE MIDDLE PATH (madhyama pratipada) - between extreme austerity, which the Buddha tried and rejected, and indulgence, which he had known as a prince. **This is the clearest single contrast with Jainism**, whose route to liberation is precisely the austerity Buddhism abandoned.

THE TRIRATNA of Buddhism - and it is NOT the Jain Triratna:

- 1 **Buddha** - the teacher
- 2 **Dhamma / Dharma** - the teaching
- 3 **Sangha** - the monastic order

THE PANCHSHEEL - the five precepts for lay followers: abstain from **killing, stealing, lying, intoxicants** and **sexual misconduct**. A workable lay ethic is a large part of why Buddhism spread where Jain austerity could not.

THE THREE PHILOSOPHICAL DOCTRINES, and the third is the crucial one:

- 1 **Pratityasamutpada** - dependent origination. Everything arises from conditions; nothing exists independently
- 2 **Anicca / anitya** - impermanence. Nothing is stable
- 3 **Anatta / anatman - NO PERMANENT SELF OR SOUL**. What we call a person is a stream of changing states

Anatta is the single most examinable doctrinal point in this chapter, because it is where Buddhism and Jainism flatly contradict each other. Jainism holds that the soul (**jiva**) is real, eternal and present in everything; **Buddhism denies a permanent self altogether**. Both accept karma and rebirth, **so Buddhism has to explain karma without a soul to carry it** - and it does so through causal continuity rather than a persisting entity. **If a question asks which religion denies the existence of the soul, the answer is Buddhism.**

3.1 The four councils

Council	When	Where, and the king	What came out of it
First	483 BCE , just after the Buddha's death	Rajgir , under Ajatashatru . Presided over by Mahakassapa	The teachings were compiled into two collections - the Vinaya Pitaka (monastic discipline) and the Sutta Pitaka (sermons)
Second	383 BCE	Vaishali , under Kalashoka	The first schism . The order split into the conservative Sthaviravadins (Theravada) and the more liberal Mahasanghikas , over points of monastic discipline
Third	c. 250 BCE	Pataliputra , under Ashoka . Presided over by Moggaliputta Tissa	The Abhidhamma Pitaka (philosophy) was added, completing the Tripitaka . Heresies were expelled, and missionaries were sent abroad, including Ashoka's son Mahendra and daughter Sanghamitra to Sri Lanka
Fourth	c. 72 CE (1st century CE)	Kundalvana, Kashmir , under Kanishka . Associated with Vasumitra and Ashvaghosha	The permanent division into MAHAYANA and HINAYANA . Texts began to be composed in Sanskrit rather than Pali

The four Buddhist councils - king, place and outcome

The council-to-king pairing is a standard matching question, and the mnemonic is that the kings run in historical order: **Ajatashatru, Kalashoka, Ashoka, Kanishka** - **Rajgir, Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kashmir**. Note that the **first two councils are the same two kings you met in F5.2's Magadhan sequence**, which is why that chapter fixed them.

KNOW · THE THREE SCHOOLS, AND THE LITERATURE

- 1 **Theravada / Hinayana** - "the lesser vehicle", the conservative school. **No image worship; the Buddha is a teacher, not a god.** Liberation is by individual effort, and the ideal is the **arhat**. Canon in **Pali**. **Survives today in Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Thailand**
 - 2 **Mahayana** - "the greater vehicle". **Image worship of the Buddha as a divine being**, and the ideal is the **bodhisattva**, who defers his own liberation to help others. Texts in **Sanskrit**. **Spread to China, Korea and Japan**, and it is the school that produced most Buddhist art
 - 3 **Vajrayana** - "the thunderbolt vehicle", the later **tantric** school, with mantras, ritual and magical practice. **Spread to Tibet**, and is associated with Bengal and Bihar in its Indian phase
- The philosophers to recognise: Nagarjuna** (Madhyamaka, the doctrine of shunyata or emptiness), **Ashvaghosha** (biographer of the Buddha, at Kanishka's court), **Vasubandhu** and **Asanga** (Yogachara), **Dignaga** and **Dharmakirti** (logic), **Buddhaghosha** (the great Theravada commentator).

The literature:

- 1 **Tripitaka** - the canon in three baskets: **Vinaya** (discipline), **Sutta** (sermons), **Abhidhamma** (philosophy). In **Pali**
- 2 **Jataka tales** - stories of the Buddha's previous births. **They are also the source of much of the narrative sculpture at Sanchi and Bharhut**, so they matter for F5.5
- 3 **Milindapanha** - "the questions of Milinda", a dialogue between the Indo-Greek king **Menander** and the monk **Nagasena**
- 4 **Buddhacharita** - by **Ashvaghosha**, in Sanskrit
- 5 **Mahavastu, Lalitavistara, Divyavadana** - Mahayana Sanskrit works on the Buddha's life

KNOW · THE ARCHITECTURE AND THE SYMBOLS - THE BRIDGE TO F5.5**Three building types, and the vocabulary is asked directly:**

- 1 **Stupa** - a solid hemispherical mound raised over a relic. Its parts: the **anda** (dome), **harmika** (railed square at the top), **chhatra** (umbrella mast), **medhi** (drum), **vedika** (railing), **torana** (gateway) and **pradakshina patha** (circumambulatory path). **Great Stupa at Sanchi**, plus **Bharhut, Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda** and **Dhamek at Sarnath**
- 2 **Chaitya** - a rock-cut **prayer hall**, apsidal, with a stupa at the closed end. **Karle, Bhaja, Bedsa, Ajanta**
- 3 **Vihara** - a **monastery**: cells for monks around a courtyard. **Nalanda, Vikramashila, Odantapuri, Ajanta**

The five symbolic events, and this is a favourite matching question - because early Buddhist art was **aniconic**, representing the Buddha through symbols rather than images before the Mahayana turn:

- 1 **Lotus and bull** - the **birth**
- 2 **Horse** - the **great renunciation**
- 3 **Bodhi tree** - the **enlightenment**
- 4 **Wheel (dharmachakra)** - the **first sermon at Sarnath**
- 5 **Stupa** - the **death, the Mahaparinirvana**

The bull-versus-horse pair is the one candidates lose. Fix it by meaning: **a bull is strength at the outset, a horse is the animal you leave on.**

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 3

- 1 Give the Buddha's birth name, clan, parents, wife and son
- 2 Name the place for each of: birth, enlightenment, first sermon, death
- 3 What were the four sights, and at what age was the Great Renunciation?
- 4 Under which tree and by which river was the enlightenment, and what is the first sermon called?
- 5 State the Four Noble Truths, and name the cause of suffering
- 6 What is the Middle Path, and how does it contrast with Jainism?
- 7 Give Buddhism's Triratna and the five Panchsheel precepts
- 8 Explain anatta, and say why it is the sharpest break with Jainism
- 9 Give all four councils with king, place and outcome
- 10 Distinguish Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana on images, ideal, language and region
- 11 Name the three parts of the Tripitaka, and who wrote the Buddhacharita
- 12 Define stupa, chaitya and vihara, and give the five symbols with their events

4. Session 4 - The Two Compared, and the Aftermath ★★★★★

They share a diagnosis and differ on the cure. Then one of them leaves India almost entirely, and the other does not.

4.1 Jainism and Buddhism side by side

Both are nastika, both were founded by eastern Kshatriyas, both reject Vedic authority, animal sacrifice and birth-based rank, both accept karma and rebirth, and both preached in the spoken language. That shared ground is why they are confused. **The table is where the marks are.**

Point	Jainism	Buddhism
Founder	Mahavira , the 24th Tirthankara - a reformer, not a founder	Siddhartha Gautama , the founder, though preceded by earlier Buddhas in tradition
Dates (traditional)	c. 540-468 BCE	c. 563-483 BCE
The soul	Jiva is REAL and eternal , present even in plants and earth particles	Anatta - NO permanent self. The sharpest doctrinal break
God	No creator God ; liberated souls are venerated	Silent on a creator God ; the Buddha is a teacher, later deified in Mahayana
Route to liberation	Extreme austerity and self-mortification , culminating in sallekhana	The Middle Path - austerity explicitly tried and rejected
Ahimsa	Absolute and literal , extending to unseen life; the most rigorous in Indian thought	Strong but moderate , judged by intention
Karma	A material substance adhering to the soul	A causal process , with no soul to adhere to
Triratna	Right faith, knowledge, conduct	Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha
Language of canon	Prakrit (Ardhamagadhi)	Pali , later Sanskrit in Mahayana

Point	Jainism	Buddhism
Sects	Digambara and Svetambara , on dress	Theravada, Mahayana, Vajrayana , on doctrine
Councils	Two - Pataliputra, then Valabhi 512 CE	Four - Rajgir, Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kashmir
Later history	Never spread outside India; survives in India today	Spread across Asia; nearly disappeared from India

The twelve points that separate Jainism from Buddhism

COMMON UPSC TRAP · THE FOUR CONFUSIONS THIS TABLE EXISTS TO PREVENT

- The two Triratnas are different.** Jain: **right faith, knowledge, conduct**. Buddhist: **Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha**. A question giving "the three jewels" must be read for which religion it means
- The soul is the opposite way round from what candidates guess. Jainism affirms the soul; Buddhism denies it.** Because Buddhism is the better-known religion, candidates often assume the more elaborate soul-doctrine is Buddhist. It is not
- Austerity belongs to Jainism, moderation to Buddhism.** The **Middle Path** is a rejection of exactly the Jain route, and the Buddha's six years of failed austerity is the biographical evidence for it
- The councils do not match. Buddhism has four with four kings; Jainism has two.** Mixing them is the commonest error in the whole chapter, and the Second Jain council at **Valabhi in 512 CE** is separated from the Buddhist councils by centuries

The reliable way to keep the pair straight in the hall: JAINISM IS THE HARDER RELIGION.

Real souls everywhere, absolute ahimsa, karma as physical matter, austerity to the point of death.

Buddhism is the moderate one on every one of those axes. Decide which side of that line the question sits on, and most option sets resolve themselves.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHY BUDDHISM NEARLY VANISHED FROM INDIA, AND JAINISM DID NOT

This is asked as a straight question, and the answer is a list of five.

- It lost its distinctiveness.** Mahayana adopted **image worship, ritual, Sanskrit and a divine Buddha** - and the more it resembled the Hinduism around it, the less reason there was to be separate from it. **The Buddha was eventually absorbed as an avatar of Vishnu**, which finished the argument
- It lost the merchant base.** The decline of long-distance trade after the Gupta period removed the **setthi** patronage that had funded monasteries since Session 1
- It became monastery-centred and lost lay contact.** Great institutions like **Nalanda and Vikramashila** concentrated wealth, scholarship and personnel, leaving the villages to Brahmanical practice
- The orthodox revival was effective.** **Shankara's Advaita** and the devotional **Bhakti** movements offered an accessible, emotionally satisfying alternative that needed no monastery
- The Turkish invasions destroyed the monasteries. Nalanda and Vikramashila were sacked around 1200 CE**, and because Buddhism's transmission ran through institutions rather than households, **destroying the institutions destroyed the religion in India**

And the contrast that makes the explanation convincing. Jainism escaped almost every one of these. **It stayed lay and household-based rather than monastery-dependent, kept a compact and wealthy urban merchant community in Gujarat, Rajasthan and Karnataka, and never blurred into the surrounding tradition** because its distinguishing practices were too demanding to be absorbed. **So the religion with the smaller institutional footprint survived, and the one with the greater one did not.** That inversion is the point worth stating, and it is the same institutional lesson Session 1 drew from the Ajivikas, turned the other way.

NOTE · THE ORTHODOX RESPONSE, IN BRIEF

The Vedic tradition did not stand still while this happened, and two developments are worth naming because they close the chapter's argument.

- 1 **Bhagavatism and the rise of devotion.** From roughly the same period, **Vasudeva-Krishna** worship and the **Bhagavata** tradition offered **bhakti** - personal devotion to a god - as a route to liberation **open to all varnas and requiring no sacrifice and no priest**. That answered the same grievance the reformers had answered, from inside the fold
- 2 **The consolidation of Shaivism and Vaishnavism** into the two great theistic traditions, with **temple worship replacing sacrifice** as the central religious act - which is what produces the temple architecture of F5.5

So the sixth-century crisis had three outcomes, not two: Jainism, Buddhism, and a reformed orthodoxy that adopted its rivals' most attractive feature. The last of the three won the largest number of people, and **the reason is the one this chapter keeps returning to - accessibility beats rigour when a religion is competing for a population.**

ACTION · WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU, AND WHAT F5.4 DOES

You now hold the sixth-century BCE religious transformation in full: why it happened, the wider field of sects it emerged from, both surviving religions in detail, the twelve points that separate them, and what became of each.

Two threads are handed forward deliberately. The **councils** gave you Ashoka and Kanishka as patrons but not as rulers - and **F5.4 takes the Mauryas and the post-Mauryan kingdoms**, where Ashoka's edicts become the central evidence and his **dhamma** is the direct political consequence of this chapter. The **stupa, chaitya, vihara** vocabulary and the **five symbols** are the raw material of **F5.5 on art and architecture**, which is the module's other highest-yield chapter.

Revise this one from the wall sheet at day 1, day 7 and day 30 without exception. It carries more discrete named items than any chapter so far, and it is the chapter where the F5.1 revision schedule earns its keep.

5. Graded Practice - 42 Questions ★★★★★

5.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. Mahavira was the

(a) twenty-fourth Tirthankara (b) twelfth Tirthankara (c) twenty-third Tirthankara (d) first Tirthankara

Q. 2. Mahavira was born at

(a) Lumbini (b) Kundagrama, near Vaishali (c) Pavapuri (d) Kapilavastu

Q. 3. Mahavira died at

(a) Kushinagar (b) Sarnath (c) Pavapuri (d) Rajgir

Q. 4. The Buddha was born at

(a) Bodh Gaya (b) Vaishali (c) Kushinagar (d) Lumbini

Q. 5. The Buddha attained enlightenment at

(a) Bodh Gaya (b) Sarnath (c) Lumbini (d) Vaishali

Q. 6. The Buddha delivered his first sermon at

(a) Rajgir (b) Sarnath (c) Vaishali (d) Kushinagar

Q. 7. The Buddha died at

(a) Bodh Gaya (b) Pavapuri (c) Kushinagar (d) Shravasti

Q. 8. The tree under which the Buddha attained enlightenment was a

(a) sal (b) mango (c) banyan (d) pipal

Q. 9. The cause of suffering, according to the Second Noble Truth, is

(a) craving or desire (b) ignorance (c) fate (d) sin

Q. 10. The number of steps in the Buddhist path to liberation is

(a) four (b) eight (c) five (d) twelve

Q. 11. The Triratna of Buddhism consists of

(a) right faith, right knowledge, right conduct (b) ahimsa, satya, asteya (c) Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha (d) dukkha, tanha, nirvana

Q. 12. The vow added by Mahavira to the four taught by Parshvanatha was

(a) ahimsa (b) satya (c) aparigraha (d) brahmacharya

Q. 13. The First Buddhist Council was held at

(a) Rajgir (b) Vaishali (c) Pataliputra (d) Kashmir

Q. 14. The Fourth Buddhist Council was held under the patronage of

(a) Ajatashatru (b) Kanishka (c) Ashoka (d) Harshavardhana

Q. 15. The Jain practice of voluntary fasting to death is called

(a) kaivalya (b) syadvada (c) sallekhana (d) aparigraha

Q. 16. The Dilwara temples are located at

(a) Shravanabelagola (b) Palitana (c) Ranakpur (d) Mount Abu

5.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 17. The test that distinguishes astika from nastika schools is

(a) acceptance of the authority of the Vedas (b) belief in God (c) belief in rebirth (d) use of Sanskrit

Q. 18. The three nastika schools of Indian philosophy are

(a) Samkhya, Yoga, Vedanta (b) Buddhism, Jainism, Charvaka (c) Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa (d) Ajivika, Ajnana, Akriyavada

Q. 19. The doctrine of strict determinism (niyati) was taught by

(a) Sanjaya Belatthaputta (b) Ajita Kesakambalin (c) Makkhali Gosala of the Ajivikas (d) Nagarjuna

Q. 20. The materialist school holding that only the perceived exists, and that there is no soul or afterlife, is

(a) Ajivika (b) Ajnana (c) Mahasanghika (d) Charvaka or Lokayata

Q. 21. The doctrine of anatta holds that

(a) there is no permanent self or soul (b) the soul is eternal and present in all things (c) the soul is material (d) liberation requires divine grace

Q. 22. Jainism differs from Buddhism on the soul in that

(a) both deny the soul (b) Jainism affirms an eternal soul present even in plants, while Buddhism denies a permanent self (c) Buddhism affirms the soul and Jainism denies it (d) neither discusses the soul

Q. 23. The Middle Path of Buddhism is a path between

(a) Hinayana and Mahayana (b) monastic and lay life (c) extreme austerity and indulgence (d) Pali and Sanskrit

Q. 24. The Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali is significant because

(a) the Abhidhamma was added (b) the Vinaya was first compiled (c) Mahayana and Hinayana divided permanently (d) the order split into Sthaviravadins and Mahasanghikas

Q. 25. The Abhidhamma Pitaka was added at the

(a) Third Council (b) Second Council (c) First Council (d) Fourth Council

Q. 26. The Digambara and Svetambara sects differ principally over

(a) the number of Tirthankaras (b) whether monks should go naked or wear white cloth (c) the authority of the Vedas (d) the practice of ahimsa

Q. 27. In early Buddhist art the horse symbolises

(a) the birth (b) the enlightenment (c) the great renunciation (d) the first sermon

Q. 28. A chaitya is

(a) a monastery with cells for monks (b) a gateway (c) a relic mound (d) a rock-cut prayer hall, apsidal, with a stupa at the closed end

Q. 29. The Milindapanha records a dialogue between

(a) the Indo-Greek king Menander and the monk Nagasena (b) the Buddha and Ananda (c) Ashoka and Moggaliputta Tissa (d) Kanishka and Vasumitra

Q. 30. The Jain canon was finally written down at

(a) the First Council at Pataliputra (b) the Second Council at Valabhi (c) Shravanabelagola (d) Mount Abu

5.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard**Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:**

List-I (Event)	List-II (Place)
A. Birth of the Buddha	1. Sarnath
B. Enlightenment	2. Kushinagar
C. First sermon	3. Lumbini
D. Mahaparinirvana	4. Bodh Gaya

(a) A-4 B-3 C-1 D-2 (b) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3

Q. 32. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Council)	List-II (King)
A. First, Rajgir	1. Kanishka
B. Second, Vaishali	2. Ashoka
C. Third, Pataliputra	3. Ajatashatru
D. Fourth, Kashmir	4. Kalashoka

(a) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3 (b) A-3 B-2 C-4 D-1 (c) A-4 B-3 C-2 D-1 (d) A-3 B-4 C-2 D-1

Q. 33. Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

(a) Buddhism prescribes extreme austerity as the route to liberation (b) Buddhism denies the existence of a permanent self (c) Jainism regards karma as a material substance adhering to the soul (d) Jainism holds that the soul is eternal and present even in plants

Q. 34. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Symbol)	List-II (Event)
A. Lotus and bull	1. First sermon
B. Horse	2. Enlightenment
C. Bodhi tree	3. Birth
D. Wheel	4. Great renunciation

(a) A-3 B-2 C-4 D-1 (b) A-3 B-4 C-2 D-1 (c) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3 (d) A-4 B-3 C-2 D-1

Q. 35. Consider the following statements: 1. Both Mahavira and the Buddha were Kshatriyas. · 2. Both rejected the authority of the Vedas. · 3. Both preached in Sanskrit. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 36. Which one of the following statements about the Triratna is correct?

(a) both religions use the same Triratna (b) only Buddhism has a Triratna (c) the Jain Triratna is Buddha, Dhamma and Sangha (d) the Jain Triratna is right faith, right knowledge and right conduct, while the Buddhist Triratna is Buddha, Dhamma and Sangha

Q. 37. Arrange the following in correct chronological order, earliest first: 1. Third Buddhist Council · 2. Death of the Buddha · 3. Fourth Buddhist Council · 4. Second Buddhist Council

(a) 2-4-1-3 (b) 2-1-4-3 (c) 4-2-1-3 (d) 2-4-3-1

Q. 38. Which one of the following statements about Mahayana Buddhism is NOT correct?

(a) It permitted image worship of the Buddha as a divine being (b) It survives today chiefly in Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Thailand (c) Its texts were composed largely in Sanskrit (d) Its ideal is the bodhisattva

Q. 39. The decline of Buddhism in India is best explained by

(a) persecution by Ashoka (b) the absence of any written canon (c) loss of distinctiveness as Mahayana absorbed image worship and ritual, loss of merchant patronage, monastery-centred organisation, the orthodox revival, and the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila around 1200 CE (d) its refusal to admit lay followers

Q. 40. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Monument)	List-II (Location)
A. Gomateshwara statue	1. Mount Abu
B. Dilwara temples	2. Odisha
C. Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves	3. Shravanabelagola
D. Caves 30 to 34, Jain group	4. Ellora

(a) A-4 B-1 C-2 D-3 (b) A-1 B-3 C-2 D-4 (c) A-3 B-2 C-1 D-4 (d) A-3 B-1 C-2 D-4

Q. 41. Consider the following statements about the causes of the sixth-century BCE reform movements: 1. Vedic sacrifice had become costly and priest-dominated. · 2. A new commercial class had wealth but no status under a hardened varna order. · 3. Ahimsa was economically rational because animal sacrifice destroyed cattle needed for agriculture. Which are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1 only

Q. 42. Which one of the following statements about Jainism is NOT correct?

(a) Mahavira attained kaivalya at the age of 42 (b) Liberation is granted by the grace of a creator God (c) The canon is in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit (d) Rishabhanatha was the first Tirthankara

6. Answers and Explanations

6.1 Level 1 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
1	a	Twenty-fourth and last. (c) The twenty-third is Parshvanatha , who taught the first four vows - the intended near-miss. (d) Rishabhanatha is the first. Note that this makes Mahavira a reformer, not the founder , on the tradition's own account
2	b	Kundagrama, near Vaishali - so in Vajji territory, the republic of F5.2. (a) Lumbini is the Buddha's birthplace, and this swap is the commonest error in the chapter. (c) Pavapuri is where Mahavira died
3	c	Pavapuri , in Bihar, aged 72. (a) Kushinagar is where the Buddha died - the matching swap to Q2

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
4	d	Lumbini , in present-day Nepal , in the Shakya republic
5	a	Bodh Gaya , on the Niranjana or Falgu river, under a pipal tree, at the age of 35
6	b	Sarnath , near Varanasi, to five disciples - the Dharmachakra Pravartana , "setting in motion the wheel of law"
7	c	Kushinagar , aged 80, among the Malla people. The event is the Mahaparinirvana
8	d	Pipal. (a) Sal is the tree associated with Mahavira's kaivalya at Jrimbhikagrama, and also with the Buddha's birth and death in tradition - which is why it is the distractor here
9	a	Craving or desire - trishna / tanha . The Four Noble Truths are a diagnosis and a prescription: there is suffering, it has a cause, the cause can be removed, and there is a path
10	b	Eight - the ashtangika marga , right view, intention, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness and concentration. (a) Four is the number of Noble Truths, which is the trap
11	c	Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha. (a) is the JAIN Triratna - right faith, knowledge and conduct - and this pair of options is the single most important distinction in the chapter
12	d	Brahmacharya . Parshvanatha taught ahimsa, satya, asteya and aparigraha ; Mahavira added chastity as the fifth
13	a	Rajgir , in 483 BCE under Ajatashatru , presided over by Mahakassapa , where the Vinaya and Sutta were compiled
14	b	Kanishka , in Kashmir in about 72 CE, associated with Vasumitra and Ashvaghosha - the council at which Mahayana and Hinayana divided permanently
15	c	Sallekhana - and it follows logically from Jain doctrine: if liberation is the shedding of karma by austerity, austerity carried to its end is the final act
16	d	Mount Abu , Rajasthan - marble carving of extraordinary fineness, built under the Solankis. (a) Shravanabelagola has the Gomateshwara statue, which is the other Jain monument most often asked

6.2 Level 2 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
17	a	Acceptance of the authority of the Vedas. (b) is the popular error the question is built on: astika does not mean theist. Samkhya is astika yet essentially non-theistic , and Jainism is nastika yet intensely concerned with the soul
18	b	Buddhism, Jainism and Charvaka. (a) and (c) list astika schools. (d) names three other heterodox sects that are real but are not the conventional trio
19	c	Makkhali Gosala , founder of the Ajivikas - everything is fixed by niyati , so effort is pointless. He spent part of Mahavira's twelve austere years in his company
20	d	Charvaka, also called Lokayata - the one nastika school that is not a religion. (a) Ajivika is determinist, (b) Ajnana sceptical
21	a	No permanent self or soul. (b) describes JAINISM's jiva - the exact opposite - and it is the option that catches candidates who assume the elaborate soul-doctrine must be the Buddhist one
22	b	Jainism affirms an eternal soul present even in plants; Buddhism denies a permanent self. (c) inverts it, which is the standard error. Both nevertheless accept karma and rebirth, so Buddhism must explain karma through causal continuity rather than a persisting entity

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
23	c	Between extreme austerity and indulgence - the Buddha had known indulgence as a prince and tried austerity for six years before rejecting it. This is the clearest single contrast with Jainism , whose route to liberation is precisely that austerity
24	d	The first schism - conservative Sthaviravadins against the liberal Mahasanghikas , over monastic discipline. (a) belongs to the Third Council and (c) to the Fourth , so the question is really testing whether the four councils are held apart
25	a	Third Council , at Pataliputra under Ashoka , presided over by Moggaliputta Tissa - which completed the Tripitaka and sent missionaries abroad including Mahendra and Sanghamitra to Sri Lanka
26	b	Naked (Digambara, "sky-clad") versus white cloth (Svetambara, "white-clad") , arising from the famine-era separation of Bhadrabahu's southern group from Sthulabhadra's. They also differ on whether women can attain liberation - Digambara says not without rebirth as a man
27	c	The great renunciation . Fix the pair by meaning: a bull is strength at the outset (birth) , a horse is the animal you leave on (renunciation) . (b) the bodhi tree is enlightenment and (d) the wheel the first sermon
28	d	A rock-cut apsidal prayer hall with a stupa at the closed end - Karle, Bhaja, Bedsa. (a) describes a vihara , a monastery, and (c) a stupa itself. Three terms, three meanings, and the paper tests exactly this
29	a	Menander and Nagasena - "the questions of Milinda", Milinda being the Indo-Greek king Menander. It is also indirect evidence of how far Greek rule in the north-west engaged with Indian thought
30	b	The Second Council at Valabhi , in 512 CE , under Devardhi Kshamasramana , in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit . Until then the canon was oral. Note the date: it is centuries after every Buddhist council , which is the separation candidates lose

6.3 Level 3 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
31	c	A-3 Lumbini birth · B-4 Bodh Gaya enlightenment · C-1 Sarnath first sermon · D-2 Kushinagar death. This is the single most reliable question in the chapter and must never be lost . Knowing only Sarnath and Bodh Gaya eliminates every wrong code
32	d	A-3 Ajatashatru · B-4 Kalashoka · C-2 Ashoka · D-1 Kanishka. The kings run in historical order, which is the mnemonic - and the first two are the same Magadhan rulers fixed in F5.2, which is why that chapter taught them
33	a	(a) is false. Buddhism REJECTS extreme austerity - the Buddha tried it for six years and abandoned it, which is the origin of the Middle Path . Austerity is the Jain route. (d), (b) and (c) are all true, and together they state the soul-and-karma contrast correctly
34	b	A-3 lotus and bull for the birth · B-4 horse for the renunciation · C-2 bodhi tree for the enlightenment · D-1 wheel for the first sermon. The stupa, not listed here, stands for the death . Early Buddhist art was aniconic , which is why these symbols exist at all
35	c	1 and 2 only . Both were eastern Kshatriyas and both rejected Vedic authority. Statement 3 is false and inverts one of the movements' most important features : they preached in Prakrit and Pali, the spoken languages , precisely against the Vedic reservation of Sanskrit for ritual. Language is one of the two enabling conditions from Session 1
36	d	Two different Triratnas . Jain: right faith, knowledge, conduct . Buddhist: Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha . (a) and (c) are the two forms the error takes , and (c) simply swaps them

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
37	a	2-4-1-3: death of the Buddha 483 BCE , Second Council 383 BCE , Third Council c. 250 BCE , Fourth Council c. 72 CE . Note the First Council is in the same year as the death, which is why it is not offered here
38	b	(b) is false - it describes Theravada / Hinayana , which survives in Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Thailand. Mahayana spread to China, Korea and Japan . (a), (d) and (c) correctly describe Mahayana: divine Buddha, the bodhisattva ideal, and Sanskrit texts
39	c	The five-part explanation. (a) is false and inverts history - Ashoka PATRONISED Buddhism , and this option exists to catch careless reading. (b) is false: the Tripitaka is a substantial canon. (d) is false: Buddhism had a well-developed lay ethic in the Panchsheel - that was one of its advantages. The instructive part is that Jainism escaped almost all five, which is why the smaller religion survived
40	d	A-3 Gomateshwara at Shravanabelagola · B-1 Dilwara at Mount Abu · C-2 Udayagiri and Khandagiri in Odisha · D-4 the Jain caves 30-34 at Ellora. Ellora's three-faith composition - Buddhist, Hindu and Jain - is itself a standard question , and these monuments recur in F5.5
41	a	All three are correct. The first two are the religious and social causes; the third is the least obvious of the six and worth stating because animal sacrifice destroyed the cattle that ploughed the fields, so ahimsa was economically rational as well as ethically appealing
42	b	(b) is false. Jainism posits NO creator God , so liberation cannot be granted by grace - it is achieved by the soul's own austerity in shedding karma. (a), (c) and (d) are all true. This is the same doctrinal point as Q21 and Q33 approached from the theological side , and it is the reason Jainism is classified nastika

7. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F5.3 - JAINISM, BUDDHISM AND THE HETERODOX SECTS

WHY THIS CHAPTER highest-yield in Module 5 · religion, philosophy and their art is the largest cluster inside the 2023 paper's nine ancient/medieval/culture questions · numbered sets everywhere · **and its stupa / chaitya / vihara vocabulary is reused whole in F5.5**

ASTIKA vs NASTIKA the test is **acceptance of the VEDAS, not theism** · **astika (6)**: Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, Vedanta · **nastika (3)**: **Buddhism, Jainism, CHARVAKA** · Samkhya is astika yet non-theistic; Jainism is nastika yet soul-centred

SIX CAUSES, AS THREE PAIRS religious: **costly priest-dominated sacrifice + the Upanishadic critique already inside the tradition** · social: **varna hardened into hereditary rank + Kshatriya resentment (both founders were Kshatriyas)** · economic: **setthis and gahapatis had wealth but no status + ahimsa was economically rational because sacrifice destroyed plough cattle** · two enablers: **Prakrit and Pali, the spoken languages**, and the **eastern republics** outside the Brahmanical heartland

OTHER HETERODOX SECTS tradition names **62-63** · **Makkhali Gosala = AJIVIKA = determinism (niyati)**, patronised by Ashoka's family · **Ajita Kesakambalin = CHARVAKA / LOKAYATA = MATERIALISM**, no soul, no rebirth, no karma - **the one nastika school that is not a religion** · **Sanjaya Belatthaputta = Ajnana = scepticism** · **Purana Kassapa = Akriyavada** · **the losers had doctrine but no durable institution; Buddhism and Jainism had a sangha, a lay ethic and patronage**

JAINISM - MAHAVIRA 24th and **LAST Tirthankara, a reformer NOT the founder** · **1st Rishabhanatha / Adinatha, emblem BULL**, named in the Rig Veda · **23rd Parshvanatha, emblem SERPENT, taught the FIRST FOUR vows** · Mahavira emblem **lion** · **born c. 540 BCE at KUNDAGRAMA near VAISHALI**, Jnatrika clan, father **Siddhartha**, mother **Trishala**, birth name **VARDHAMANA**, wife **Yashoda** · **renounced at 30, 12 years of austerity, kaivalya at 42 at JRIMBHIKAGRAMA under a SAL tree** · titles **Mahavira, Jina, Kevalin** · preached 30 years in Prakrit · **died c. 468 BCE at PAVAPURI**, aged 72

JAIN DOCTRINE FIVE VOWS: ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha, BRAHMACHARYA (the one Mahavira ADDED) · **TRIRATNA = right FAITH, right KNOWLEDGE, right CONDUCT** · **jiva and ajiva - souls exist even in plants and earth particles, which is why Jain ahimsa is the most rigorous in Indian thought** · **karma is a MATERIAL SUBSTANCE adhering to the soul** · **no creator God, so liberation is by AUSTERITY not grace** · **syadvada / anekantavada** - many-sidedness, the blind men and the elephant · **SALLEKHANA** - voluntary fasting to death, the most distinctive Jain practice · **accepts karma and rebirth; rejects Vedas, sacrifice, priests, birth-rank and a creator God**

JAIN COUNCILS AND SECTS **1st PATALIPUTRA** under **CHANDRAGUPTA MAURYA**, convener **STHULABHADRA** - follows a famine during which **Bhadrabahu** led a group south · **2nd VALABHI 512 CE** under **DEVARDHI KSHAMASRAMANA** - the canon **WRITTEN DOWN** in **ARDHAMAGADHI PRAKRIT** · **DIGAMBARA "sky-clad", naked, Bhadrabahu's southern line, women CANNOT attain liberation** · **SVETAMBARA "white-clad", white cloth, Sthulabhadra's line, women CAN** · canon **Agamas / 12 Angas, Kalpasutra** by **Bhadrabahu**

JAIN PATRONS AND MONUMENTS **Bimbisara, Ajatashatru, Chandragupta Maurya** (by tradition died by **sallekhana** at **Shravanabelagola**), **Kharavela of Kalinga (HATHIGUMPHA inscription)**, **Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas, Gangas** · **DILWARA** - **Mount Abu, marble, Solankis** · **GOMATESHWARA / BAHUBALI** - **Shravanabelagola, monolithic ~57 ft, Chavundaraya** · **UDAYAGIRI and KHANDAGIRI** - **Odisha** · **ELLORA caves 30-34 incl. Indra Sabha** · **Ranakpur, Palitana, Girnar**

BUDDHA - THE FIVE PLACES born c. 563 BCE at **LUMBINI** (Nepal, Shakyas republic), name **Siddhartha Gautama**, father **Suddhodana**, mother **Maha Maya**, aunt **Prajapati Gautami**, wife **Yashodhara**, son **Rahula** · **MAHABHINISHKRAMANA** at 29 after the **four sights** (old man, sick man, corpse, ascetic) · teachers **Alara Kalama** and **Ramaputta Uddaka**, then **six years of austerity** **ABANDONED** → the Middle Path · **ENLIGHTENMENT** at 35 at **BODH GAYA**, river **Niranjana/Falgu**, under a **PIPAL** · titles **Buddha, Tathagata, Shakyamuni** · **FIRST SERMON** at **SARNATH = DHARMACHAKRA PRAVARTANA** · preached **45 years in PALI**; patrons **Bimbisara, Ajatashatru, Prasenajit** · **died c. 483 BCE at KUSHINAGAR** aged 80 among the **Malla** = **MAHAPARINIRVANA** · traditional dates 563-483 BCE are what option sets use, though much scholarship places him a century later

BUDDHIST DOCTRINE FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS: **dukkha** · **cause = CRAVING (trishna/tanha)** · it can be ended · the path · **EIGHTFOLD PATH** right view, intention, speech, action, **livelihood**, effort, mindfulness, concentration · **MIDDLE PATH** between austerity and indulgence · **TRIRATNA = BUDDHA, DHAMMA, SANGHA** · **PANCHASHEEL** no killing, stealing, lying, intoxicants, sexual misconduct · **pratityasamutpada** dependent origination · **anicca** impermanence · **ANATTA - NO PERMANENT SELF, the sharpest break with Jainism**, so karma runs by causal continuity with no soul to carry it

FOUR COUNCILS - kings in historical order 1st **RAJGIR 483 BCE, AJATASHATRU, Mahakassapa** → **VINAYA + SUTTA** · 2nd **VAISHALI 383 BCE, KALASHOKA** → **FIRST SCHISM, Sthaviravadins vs Mahasanghikas** · 3rd **PATALIPUTRA c. 250 BCE, ASHOKA, Moggaliputta Tissa** → **ABHIDHAMMA** added, **TRIPITAKA** complete, missionaries incl. **Mahendra and Sanghamitra** to Sri Lanka · 4th **KUNDALVANA KASHMIR c. 72 CE, KANISHKA, Vasumitra and Ashvaghosha** → **MAHAYANA / HINAYANA split, Sanskrit**

THREE SCHOOLS THERAVADA / HINAYANA no images, Buddha a teacher, ideal the **arhat, PALI**, survives in **Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand** · **MAHAYANA** image worship, divine Buddha, ideal the **BODHISATTVA, SANSKRIT**, spread to **China, Korea, Japan**, produced most Buddhist art ·

VAJRAYANA tantric, mantras, spread to **TIBET** · philosophers **Nagarjuna (shunyata), Ashvaghosha, Vasubandhu and Asanga, Dignaga and Dharmakirti, Buddhaghosha**

BUDDHIST LITERATURE AND ART TRIPITAKA = VINAYA (discipline) + SUTTA (sermons) + ABHIDHAMMA (philosophy) · **Jatakas** = previous births, and the source of narrative sculpture at Sanchi and Bharhut · **Milindapanha = MENANDER and NAGASENA** · **Buddhacharita = ASHVAGHOSHA** · **STUPA** relic mound - anda, harmika, chhatra, medhi, vedika, torana, pradakshina patha; **Sanchi, Bharhut, Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda** · **CHAITYA** rock-cut prayer hall - **Karle, Bhaja, Bedsa** · **VIHARA** monastery - **Nalanda, Vikramashila, Odantapuri** · **FIVE SYMBOLS:** lotus+bull = **BIRTH** · horse = **RENUNCIATION** · bodhi tree = **ENLIGHTENMENT** · wheel = **FIRST SERMON** · stupa = **DEATH** (early art was **aniconic**)

THE TWELVE-POINT CONTRAST soul **Jain real and eternal / Buddhist NONE** · route **austerity + sallekhana / the MIDDLE PATH** · ahimsa **absolute / moderate by intention** · karma **material substance / causal process** · Triratna **faith-knowledge-conduct / Buddha-Dhamma-Sangha** · canon **Ardhamagadhi Prakrit / Pali then Sanskrit** · sects **Digambara-Svetambara on DRESS / Theravada-Mahayana-Vajrayana on DOCTRINE** · councils **TWO / FOUR** · later **never left India but survives / crossed Asia but nearly vanished here** · the hall shortcut: **JAINISM IS THE HARDER RELIGION on every axis**

WHY BUDDHISM DECLINED IN INDIA - **FIVE lost distinctiveness** as Mahayana took on images, ritual and Sanskrit, and the Buddha was absorbed as an **avatar of Vishnu** · **lost merchant patronage** as long-distance trade fell after the Guptas · **monastery-centred**, losing village and lay contact · **orthodox revival** through **Shankara's Advaita** and **Bhakti** · **Turkish invasions sacked NALANDA and VIKRAMASHILA c. 1200 CE**, and a religion transmitted through institutions dies when they do · **Jainism escaped almost all five - lay, household-based, compact wealthy merchant community, too demanding to be absorbed**

THE THIRD OUTCOME the orthodoxy reformed itself too - **Bhagavatism and Vasudeva-Krishna worship offered BHAKTI, open to all varnas with no sacrifice and no priest**, and **Shaivism and Vaishnavism consolidated with TEMPLE WORSHIP replacing sacrifice**, which is what produces the temple architecture of F5.5 · **so the crisis had THREE outcomes, and the most accessible one won the most people**

8. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F5.3 - JAINISM, BUDDHISM AND THE HETERODOX SECTS

ASTIKA vs NASTIKA = acceptance of the VEDAS, NOT theism

Nastika three: BUDDHISM, JAINISM, CHARVAKA

Causes: costly sacrifice · Upanishadic critique · varna hardened · Kshatriya resentment · wealthy statusless merchants · ahimsa saved plough cattle

Enablers: PRAKRIT/PALI not Sanskrit · the eastern REPUBLICS

Makkhali Gosala = AJIVIKA = DETERMINISM (niyati)

Charvaka / Lokayata = MATERIALISM, no soul, no rebirth - not a religion

MAHAVIRA = 24th and LAST Tirthankara, NOT the founder

1st Rishabhanatha (BULL) · 23rd Parshvanatha (SERPENT) taught FIRST FOUR vows

Born KUNDAGRAMA near VAISHALI c. 540 BCE · Vardhamana · renounced 30 · kaivalya 42 · died PAVAPURI c. 468 BCE

FIVE VOWS: ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha, BRAHMACHARYA (Mahavira's addition)

JAIN TRIRATNA = right FAITH, KNOWLEDGE, CONDUCT

Jiva in plants and earth · karma is MATERIAL · NO creator God · liberation by AUSTERITY

SYADVADA = many-sidedness · SALLEKHANA = fasting to death

Jain councils: PATALIPUTRA (Chandragupta Maurya, Sthulabhadra) · VALABHI 512 CE (canon written, ARDHAMAGADHI)

DIGAMBARA naked, women CANNOT · SVETAMBARA white cloth, women CAN

Jain sites: DILWARA-Mount Abu · GOMATESHWARA-Shravanabelagola ·

UDAYAGIRI/KHANDAGIRI-Odisha · ELLORA 30-34

Kharavela of Kalinga = HATHIGUMPHA inscription

BUDDHA: LUMBINI born · BODH GAYA enlightened (PIPAL) · SARNATH first sermon ·

KUSHINAGAR died

Siddhartha Gautama · Siddhodana + Maha Maya · Yashodhara + Rahula · renounced at 29 · enlightened at 35 · died at 80

FOUR SIGHTS: old man, sick man, corpse, ascetic · six years of austerity ABANDONED

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS · cause of suffering = CRAVING (tanha) · EIGHTFOLD PATH · MIDDLE PATH

BUDDHIST TRIRATNA = BUDDHA, DHAMMA, SANGHA · PANCHSHEEL = five lay precepts

ANATTA = NO PERMANENT SOUL — the sharpest break with Jainism

COUNCILS: 1 RAJGIR-AJATASHATRU · 2 VAISHALI-KALASHOKA · 3 PATALIPUTRA-ASHOKA · 4 KASHMIR-KANISHKA

1st → Vinaya+Sutta · 2nd → FIRST SCHISM · 3rd → ABHIDHAMMA, Tripitaka complete · 4th → MAHAYANA/HINAYANA

THERAVADA: no images, arhat, PALI, Sri Lanka/Myanmar/Thailand

MAHAYANA: images, BODHISATTVA, SANSKRIT, China/Korea/Japan · VAJRAYANA: tantric, TIBET

TRIPITAKA = VINAYA + SUTTA + ABHIDHAMMA · Milindapanha = MENANDER + NAGASENA · Buddhacharita = ASHVAGHOSHA

STUPA = relic mound (Sanchi) · CHAITYA = prayer hall (Karle) · VIHARA = monastery (Nalanda)

SYMBOLS: bull/lotus BIRTH · HORSE RENUNCIATION · TREE ENLIGHTENMENT · WHEEL FIRST SERMON · STUPA DEATH

JAINISM IS THE HARDER RELIGION on every axis - use this to resolve option sets

Buddhism declined: lost distinctiveness (Buddha as Vishnu avatar) · lost merchant money · monastery-bound · Shankara + Bhakti · NALANDA and VIKRAMASHILA sacked c. 1200 CE

Jainism survived because it was LAY, household-based, compact, wealthy and too demanding to absorb - the smaller institutional footprint outlasted the larger one